



Charbonnet & Associates Planners and Consultants, Inc.

Website — Summary & Technical Documentation

Site overview, September 2026 polish pass, and a complete build reference

Prepared: September 5, 2026

Repository: BernardCharbonnetPortfolio

Commit: 77b5a55 — “Polish firm site: responsive nav, alignment, and firm-grade cleanup”

Contents

1. Executive Summary

This document describes the public website for Charbonnet & Associates Planners and Consultants, Inc. (CAPC), a New Orleans- and St. Louis-based planning, consulting, and legal-advisory firm. It records what the site contains, the changes made during the September 2026 polish pass, and the full technical reference required to rebuild or maintain it.

The site is a single-page, statically hosted marketing website. It has no server-side component, no build step, and no third-party runtime dependencies beyond a web-font stylesheet. Three source files (HTML, CSS, JavaScript) plus one background video comprise the entire deliverable.

Design language: navy (#0B1C3D) and gold (#C9A84C) on a warm cream ground — restrained, high-contrast, and appropriate for a government- and institution-facing professional-services firm. Typographic pairing of Playfair Display (display), Source Serif 4 (body), and Barlow (UI/labels). Visual references: Morgan Lewis, Littler, and Seyfarth.

2. Site Overview

The site is one continuously scrolling page. The fixed header links to in-page anchors. Sections, in document order:

#	Section (anchor)	Purpose / contents
1	Header / nav	Fixed top bar: wordmark + 7 anchor links (About, Services, Projects, Our Team, Social Justice, Legal Advisory, Contact Us). Collapses to a toggle menu at $\leq 1080\text{px}$.
2	Hero (#home)	Full-viewport section with muted looping background video, headline “Planning. Consulting. Building What Matters.”, firm summary, two calls-to-action, and a “By the Numbers” statistics card.
3	Credentials strip (.trust-bar)	Slim navy band: “At a Glance” — DBE certification, year established, \$3B+ construction advised, practice areas.
4	Firm Overview (#about)	Two-column: narrative history + mission pull-quote, and a sticky “Select Client Relationships” card grouped into Aviation and Public Agencies & Education.
5	Services (#services)	Six service cards in a 3-column grid; two are visually emphasized (“Core Practice”). Each card: icon, title, description, capability bullets.
6	Projects (#projects)	Two full-width flagship engagement cards (Lambert-St. Louis Airport; LCTCS ACT 360) plus a 3-column grid of 12 selected projects with color-coded category tags and locations.
7	Our Team (#team)	Five leadership cards: navy header with monogram avatar, biography, and a credential list.
8	Social & Environmental Justice (#justice)	Full navy section: three definition cards + the firm’s six-step community-engagement methodology.
9	Legal Advisory (#legal)	Narrative on the affiliated Law Office of Bernard L. Charbonnet, Jr. + a 10-item “Areas of Legal Practice” chip grid.
10	Contact (#contact)	Full navy section: headquarters / branch / key-contact cards + a message form

#	Section (anchor)	Purpose / contents
		(front-end only).
11	Footer	Wordmark, secondary nav, auto-updating copyright line.

3. September 2026 Polish Pass — What Changed

The update kept all content and the existing color palette. It focused on responsive behavior, alignment consistency, accessibility, and firm-appropriate presentation.

3.1 Navigation & responsiveness

- Added a true mobile navigation menu. The <header> now sits at the top of the document; an animated hamburger button toggles a full-width dropdown panel of stacked links with a full-width “Contact Us” button. The menu closes on link tap, on Escape, and when the viewport is resized back above 1080px. Navigation collapses to the toggle at ≤1080px (seven links become cramped before that).
- Fixed the fixed-header anchor offset: `html { scroll-padding-top }` so in-page jumps no longer land underneath the header.
- Rebuilt active-section highlighting on IntersectionObserver instead of a per-tick scroll listener.
- Unified the content max-width to a single token (`--maxw: 1240px`) across header, sections, credentials strip, and footer — these had drifted between 1300px and ad-hoc values.
- Converted section padding and gutters to fluid clamp() values; consolidated breakpoints to 1080 / 960 / 720 / 520 plus reduced-motion and print.
- Removed an inline grid-column: `span 3` and inline gradient on a flagship project card that broke the grid at tablet widths; replaced with `grid-column: 1 / -1` and an `.alt` modifier class.

3.2 Content & presentation

- Replaced the internal-sounding “Active Pursuits / Priority / target contracts” banner with a neutral, client-appropriate “At a Glance” credentials strip. (The two flagship engagements still appear as featured cards in the Projects section.)
- Split the client list into “Aviation” and “Public Agencies & Education” groups and replaced inconsistent inline SVG list markers that were breaking alignment with a single clean marker style.
- Grammar, tense, and typography corrections (em/en dashes, curly quotes, “advice” vs. “advise”).
- Footer copyright year now updates automatically from the browser clock.
- Corrected the stylesheet reference capitalization in the HTML (`styles.css` → `Styles.css`) so it resolves on case-sensitive hosts.

3.3 Accessibility

- Skip-to-content link; semantic landmarks (header / main / footer / nav); each section labelled via `aria-labelledby`.
- Toggle button exposes `aria-expanded` / `aria-controls` and swaps its `aria-label` between “Open” and “Close”.

- Visible :focus-visible outlines on all interactive elements; minimum 46px touch targets for buttons.
- Form fields have real <label for> associations and autocomplete hints; submission status announced via role=status / aria-live=polite.
- prefers-reduced-motion: reduce disables animations and hides the background video. A print stylesheet strips the header, video, and form.

3.4 Files touched

Index.html — 987 lines changed · **Styles.css** — 1,383 lines changed · **main.js** — 328 lines changed. Net: 1,206 insertions, 1,492 deletions across the three files (commit 77b5a55).

4. Technology Stack

Layer	Technology	Notes
Markup	HTML5 (semantic)	Single document, Index.html. Landmark elements, ARIA attributes, Open Graph + description meta, theme-color.
Styling	CSS3 — hand-authored, single file	Custom properties (design tokens), CSS Grid + Flexbox, clamp() fluid type/space, media queries, backdrop-filter, CSS mask for the map-pin icon, keyframe + transition animations. No preprocessor.
Behavior	Vanilla JavaScript (ES5-compatible)	One file, ~150 lines, wrapped in an IIFE with "use strict". No framework, no polyfills, no bundler.
Fonts	Google Fonts (CDN stylesheet)	Playfair Display, Source Serif 4, Barlow. Loaded via <link> with preconnect. Each family has a system fallback.
Icons	Inline SVG	Hand-placed <svg> markup. No icon font or icon library.
Media	MP4 video (H.264)	ConstructionVideo.mp4, ~9.0 MB. autoplay + muted + loop + playsinline; preload=metadata.
Build	None	No package.json, no compile/transpile/minify step. Source files are the deployed files.
Hosting	Any static host	GitHub Pages, Netlify, Vercel, S3 + CloudFront, Apache/nginx, etc. No runtime, database, or environment configuration.
Version control	Git	Repository "BernardCharbonnetPortfolio". main branch. Remote: origin/main.

Third-party runtime dependencies: one — the Google Fonts stylesheet. The site renders fully (with fallback fonts) if that request is blocked.

4.1 Browser support

Targets modern evergreen browsers (Chrome, Edge, Firefox, Safari; iOS Safari and Android Chrome). Key feature notes:

- backdrop-filter — used with the -webkit- prefix for Safari; degrades to a solid navy bar if unsupported.
- IntersectionObserver — ~97% global support; the script reveals all content immediately when it is absent, and a 2.5s failsafe reveals content even if the observer never fires.
- CSS mask — used with the -webkit- prefix for the project location pin.
- CSS Grid, custom properties, clamp() — required; no IE11 support.

5. Project Structure

```
BernardCharbonnetPortfolio/
├─ Index.html           Entire page markup (all sections)
├─ Styles.css           All styling; 17 numbered sections
├─ main.js              All interactive behavior (IIFE)
├─ ConstructionVideo.mp4 Hero background video (~9 MB)
└─ .git/                Version control
```

Filename casing matters. The files are `Index.html`, `Styles.css`, `main.js`, `ConstructionVideo.mp4` with those exact capitalizations, and the references inside `Index.html` match. Case-sensitive hosts (most Linux servers) will 404 on a mismatch.

5.1 Styles.css — internal organization

#	Section	#	Section
1	Design tokens (:root)	10	Team (#team)
2	Reset & base	11	Social & Environmental Justice (#justice)
3	Site header / navigation	12	Legal Advisory (#legal)
4	Hero (#home)	13	Contact (#contact)
5	Credentials strip	14	Footer
6	Shared section utilities	15	Animations
7	Firm Overview (#about)	16	Responsive (media queries)
8	Services (#services)	17	Reduced motion & print
9	Projects (#projects)		

6. Design System

6.1 Color tokens (:root custom properties)

Token	Value	Role
--navy	#0B1C3D	Primary dark; section backgrounds, header, footer text ground
--navy-mid	#152B5E	Gradient midpoint
--navy-light	#1E3A7A	Hover states, avatar fill, credentials-strip gradient end
--navy-darker	#060F1E	Footer background
--gold	#C9A84C	Primary accent; CTAs, rules, markers, active states
--gold-light	#E2C97A	Accent text on dark backgrounds, hover
--gold-pale	#F5E9C4	Subtle borders / idle client-list marker
--cream	#F9F6EF	Page background (light sections)
--white	FFFFFF	Cards on cream, body text on navy
--gray	#6B7280	Secondary text
--gray-light	#E5E7EB	Borders, dividers
--text-dark	#1A1A2E	Primary body text
--text-body	#3A3A4A	Long-form paragraph text in light sections

6.2 Layout & spacing tokens

Token	Value	Purpose
--maxw	1240px	Max content width, all major containers
--radius	8px	Card / panel corner radius
--radius-sm	4px	Inputs, chips, small elements
--header-h	68px (60px at ≤520px)	Fixed header height; drives scroll-padding and mobile-menu offset
--section-y	clamp(64px, 9vw, 108px)	Vertical section padding
--gutter	clamp(1.15rem, 5vw, 2rem)	Horizontal page gutter
--ease	cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 0.2, 1)	Shared easing curve
--shadow-card	0 4px 24px rgba(11,28,61,.07)	Resting card shadow
--shadow-lift	0 16px 48px rgba(11,28,61,.13)	Hover / raised card shadow

6.3 Typography

Family	Weights loaded	Usage	Fallback
Playfair Display	400, 600, 700, 900	Display headings, wordmark, stat numbers, avatars	serif
Source Serif 4	300/400/600 + 300/400 italic	Body copy, hero subtitle (italic), pull-quotes	Georgia, serif

Family	Weights loaded	Usage	Fallback
Barlow	300, 400, 500, 600, 700	Nav, labels, eyebrows, buttons, card body, form controls	sans-serif

Fluid heading sizes: hero-title clamp(2.3rem, 5.2vw, 4.1rem) · section-title clamp(1.75rem, 3.6vw, 2.7rem). Eyebrow labels are uppercase Barlow ~0.72rem with 0.16em letter-spacing and a 28px gold rule via ::before.

6.4 Responsive breakpoints

Max-width	Primary changes
1080px	Navigation collapses to the hamburger toggle; primary nav becomes a fixed full-width dropdown panel.
960px	Hero drops to one column (stats card below, capped ~460px). Services / Projects / Team grids → 2 columns. About, Legal, Justice, Contact → 1 column. Sticky client card unpins. Flagship project cards stack their two halves.
720px	Services / Projects / Team → 1 column. Legal practice chips → 2 columns. Credentials-strip label wraps above the list. Footer stacks and centers.
520px	--header-h drops to 60px. Hero buttons go full-width and stack. Card padding tightens. Legal chips → 1 column. Wordmark subtitle hidden (shows "CAPC" only).
(feature) prefers-reduced-motion	All animation/transition durations ~0; reveal elements shown immediately; background video hidden.
(feature) print	Header, video, toggle, and contact form removed; colors flattened to black on white; cards avoid page breaks.

6.5 Layout techniques

- CSS Grid for every multi-column region (grids named in §6.4). Flexbox for one-dimensional rows (header, stat list, info lines, footer).
- Flagship project cards span the full grid with grid-column: 1 / -1.
- Team cards use flex-direction: column with margin-top: auto on the credential list so credentials bottom-align regardless of bio length.
- The client-relationships card is position: sticky; top: calc(var(--header-h) + 24px) on desktop, static below 960px.
- Card hover: translateY(-3 to -4px) + --shadow-lift; service cards also reveal a 4px gold top rule via a scaleX transition on ::before.
- Scroll-reveal: JS adds .reveal (opacity 0 / translateY(20px)); .is-visible transitions it in.

7. JavaScript Behavior (main.js)

A single IIFE in strict mode, run from a `<script>` at the end of `<body>`. It reads a `prefers-reduced-motion` media query once and then wires five features. No feature throws if its target elements are absent.

7.1 Mobile navigation toggle

- Click on `#navToggle` adds/removes `.nav-open` on `#siteHeader` and flips `aria-expanded` plus the `aria-label` text.
- CSS animates the three hamburger bars into an X and expands `.primary-nav` from `max-height: 0` to the viewport height.
- Menu closes on: any click landing on an `<a>` inside the nav; Escape keydown; window resize above 1080px.

7.2 Active-link scrollspy

An `IntersectionObserver` watches every `main section[id]` with `rootMargin: -45% 0px -50% 0px`. When a section crosses the upper band, its matching `.nav-links a` gets `.is-active` (gold). Falls back silently if `IntersectionObserver` is unavailable.

7.3 Contact form handler

- On submit: `preventDefault`, then `form.checkValidity()`. If invalid, sets the status line and calls `reportValidity()` (native bubbles).
- If valid: the submit button switches to a green “Message Sent” confirmation and is disabled; the status line thanks the user; `form.reset()` clears fields.
- Front-end only — no data is transmitted. See §10 for wiring a backend.

7.4 Scroll-reveal animations

- Targets: `.service-card`, `.project-item`, `.project-featured`, `.team-card`, `.justice-def-card` (28 elements).
- With `reduced-motion` or no `IntersectionObserver`: all elements get `.reveal.is-visible` at once.
- Otherwise each element is observed (threshold 0.12); on intersect it gets `.is-visible` and is unobserved.
- Failsafe: a 2,500ms `setTimeout` adds `.is-visible` to all targets so content can never remain hidden.

7.5 Footer year

`#footerYear` `textContent` is set to `new Date().getFullYear()`.

7.6 Required element IDs / hooks

Selector	Used for
<code>#siteHeader</code>	Receives <code>.nav-open</code>
<code>#navToggle</code>	Hamburger button (<code>aria-expanded</code> / <code>aria-controls</code> / <code>aria-label</code>)
<code>#primaryNav</code>	Collapsible nav container
<code>.nav-links a</code>	Scrollspy active-state targets
<code>main section[id]</code>	Scrollspy observed sections

Selector	Used for
.contact-form / button[type=submit] / #formStatus	Form handler + status region
.service-card, .project-item, .project-featured, .team-card, .justice-def-card	Reveal-on-scroll targets
#footerYear	Auto year

8. Local Development

The site must be served over HTTP — opening `Index.html` via `file://` breaks relative asset paths and the web-font request. Any static server works; a zero-install option:

```
cd BernardCharbonnetPortfolio
python3 -m http.server 8000
# open http://localhost:8000/Index.html
```

Alternatives:

- `npx serve .` (Node)
- `php -S localhost:8000`
- VS Code “Live Server” extension (adds auto-reload)

There is nothing to compile, install, or watch. Edit a source file and refresh the browser.

8.1 Editing guide

To change...	Edit
Colors / spacing / fonts globally	Styles.css §1 (:root tokens)
Any section's copy or structure	Index.html — sections are commented and in visual order
A service / project / team entry	Duplicate an existing <code><article></code> card in the relevant grid in <code>Index.html</code>
Nav links	The <code><ul class="nav-links"></code> in the header and the mirror list in <code><footer></code>
Breakpoint behavior	Styles.css §16
Interactive behavior	main.js (five labeled blocks)
Background video	Replace <code>ConstructionVideo.mp4</code> (keep the filename) or change the <code><source></code> in the hero

9. Deployment

Publish by copying four files to any static host. No configuration, secrets, or runtime.

GitHub Pages

```
git push origin main
# Repo → Settings → Pages → Source: main / root
# Rename Index.html to index.html, or add a redirect,
# since Pages expects a lowercase index.
```

Netlify / Vercel (drag-and-drop or Git)

- Build command: none. Publish directory: the repository root.
- Set the site's default document to `Index.html` if the platform assumes `index.html`.

Traditional server (Apache / nginx)

Upload the four files to the web root. Recommended: enable gzip/brotli for .html/.css/.js, send long-lived cache headers for the .mp4, and serve over HTTPS so the fonts and video load without mixed-content warnings.

Pre-launch checklist: lowercase the entry filename for the host if needed · add a favicon · compress or add a poster image for the video · connect the contact form to a backend · have the firm review all copy, names, and figures for accuracy.

10. Known Limitations & Recommended Next Steps

Area	Current state	Recommendation
Contact form	Captures input and shows a success state, but sends nothing.	Point the <form> at Formspree / Netlify Forms / EmailJS, or a small serverless function. Add spam protection (honeypot or hCaptcha).
Background video	~9 MB MP4, no poster frame.	Re-encode to ~1–2 MB (720p, CRF ~28), add a poster image, and consider a WebM source. Already hidden under prefers-reduced-motion.
Favicon / touch icons	None.	Add favicon.ico + a 180×180 apple-touch-icon and a small web manifest.
Entry filename	Index.html (capital I).	Rename to index.html for hosts that expect the lowercase default.
Single page	All content on one scroll; no deep links to individual bios or practice pages.	Optional: split Team and Legal into sub-pages if content grows; add structured data (Organization / LocalBusiness JSON-LD).
Analytics	None.	Add privacy-respecting analytics (e.g., Plausible/Fathom) if measurement is needed.
Content accuracy	Carried over from the existing draft.	Firm to verify all names, titles, dates, dollar figures, and client references before public launch.

11. Change Log

Date	Commit	Summary
2026-09-05	77b5a55	Polish pass: mobile navigation, responsive alignment, unified max-width and fluid spacing, credentials strip replaces internal “Active Pursuits” banner, accessibility (skip link, focus states, reduced-motion, labeled form), grammar/typography, auto year, stylesheet-casing fix.
earlier	1ae43d3	Background video added; font sizing adjustments.
earlier	4491d2e	First draft of the website.